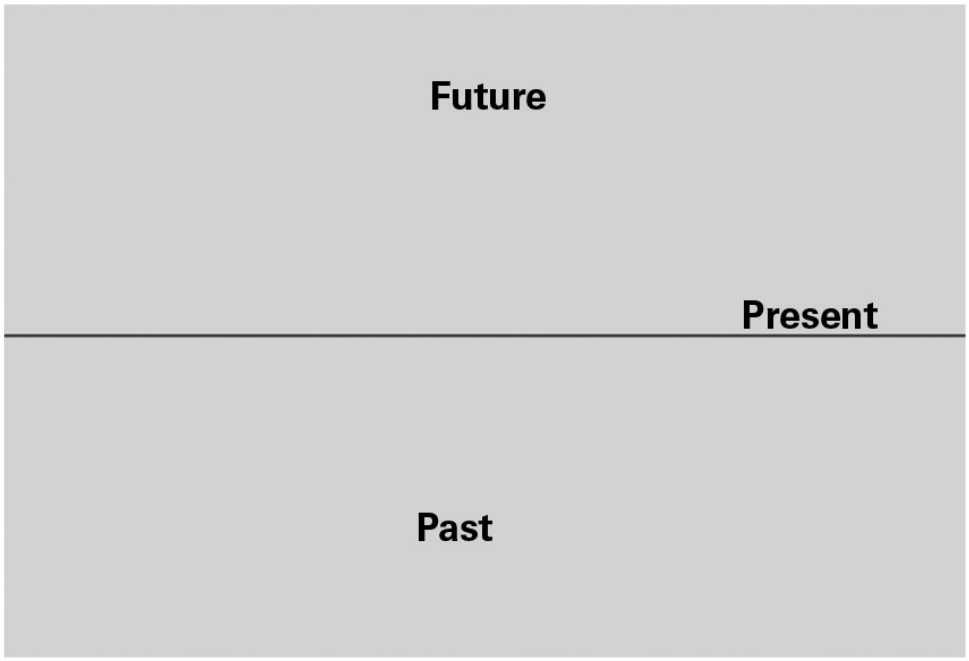
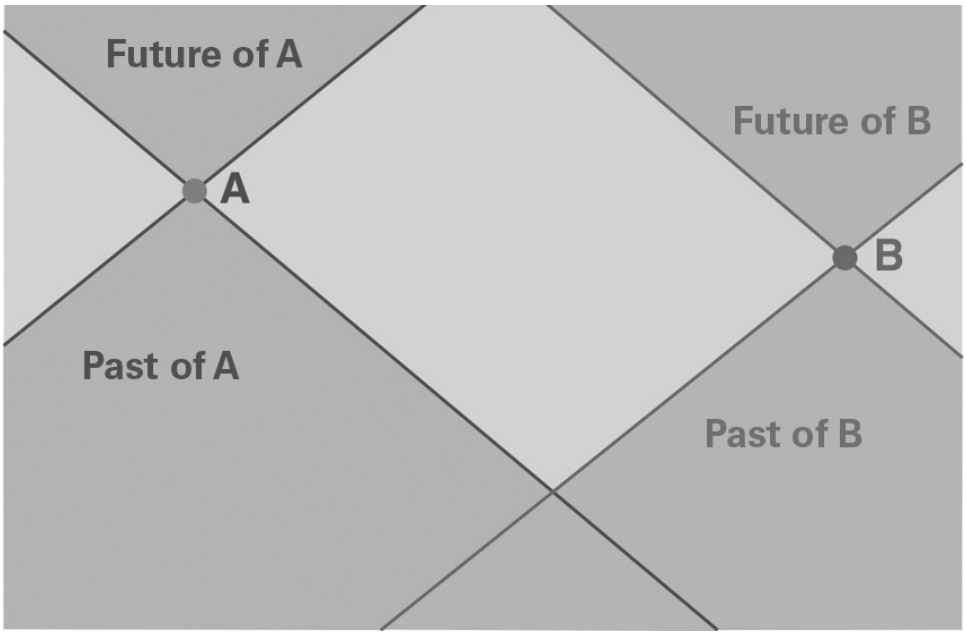




(Physicists have the habit in such diagrams, I don’t know why, of placing the future above and the past below—the opposite of how it is done in genealogical trees.)

Every event has its past, its future, and a part of the universe that is neither past nor future, just as every person has forebears, descendants, and others who are neither forebears nor descendants.

Light travels along the oblique lines that delimit these cones. This is why we call them “light cones.” It is customary, as in the previous diagram, to draw these lines at an angle of forty-five degrees, but it would be more realistic to make them more horizontal, like this: